

become pressure points in the future? It may seem harsh, but doing due diligence now could save you tens of thousands of dollars down the line.

2. Potential health problems. Is your partner healthy? Does he or she take care of himself or herself? If not, it's going to cost you later. You've probably heard the old saying, "Go look at the mother." Here's the less patronizing and updated version: "Go look at the parents." If you want to know how your partner will age, take a peek at Mom and Dad. Are they overweight? Diabetic? What medications are they taking? You'll get a lot of information about who your partner is going to be in the future by studying his stock.

You can also get some definitive answers with a little cash and a spit swab. Angelina Jolie made waves in 2013 by undergoing a preventive double mastectomy after learning she faced an 87 percent risk of breast cancer. She's being lauded far and wide as a true hero of our age. What would you do differently if you knew which diseases you were genetically predisposed to? Thanks to the wonders of modern medicine, you can now know. Organizations like 23andMe offer basic genetic testing: register online, and for only \$99, they'll send you a spit kit. They test for more than 40 inherited conditions. I suggest you do this with your partner—make a date out of it. Take a trip to the post office to send in your spit samples, and once you've gotten the results, read them together. It's a relatively cheap and efficient way to understand how your genes impact your health and your wallet. Who knows? It might end up saving your life or your partner's. At very least, it's information you'll want to have moving forward.

I went to business school with a guy who married the love of his life. A few years after graduation, they had beautiful